

C2-08 Mini-Lab - RiverCart Management Review

Cumulative business-analysis and communication practice

SCENARIO

The CEO asks: 'Tell me why growth slowed and what we should do before next quarter.' Finance, Growth, Operations and Data Engineering have different concerns. The evidence shows slower revenue growth, lower repeat purchase, weaker margin, higher late delivery and higher acquisition cost, with material data limitations.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES

Discovery/open-question brief; observation/inference/recommendation note; prioritized option matrix; executive summary; primary recommendation with owner/guardrail/review rule; uncertainty/update plan; management defense Q&A; engineering handoff for delivery-event reliability. Do not invent causal proof.

PASS SIGNAL

A decision owner can understand the recommendation quickly; observations are distinguishable from hypotheses; uncertainty could be traced to the evidence; stakeholder conflicts and non-negotiables are visible; follow-up/engineering work has owner and acceptance criteria.

RiverCart Simulation - Defense and changed retry

Review opens only after the complete first attempt is saved

90-SECOND DEFENSE

Answer: What exactly slowed? What is observed versus inferred? What evidence makes delivery reliability a plausible contributor but not proven cause? Why this action before more acquisition? What would make you change the recommendation? Which owner must approve margin/metric definitions? What engineering evidence is still missing?

CHANGED RETRY

After review, close it and prepare a shorter CFO version under a 50% lower intervention budget. Preserve the business objective, ledger-aligned margin and uncertainty; modify the action/priority rather than pretending the evidence changed.

EVIDENCE

Simulation workbook + 120-word executive memo + option/priority matrix + defense answers + uncertainty statement + engineering handoff + decision log.